Monocultures

☞ **1** Add the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the passage below.

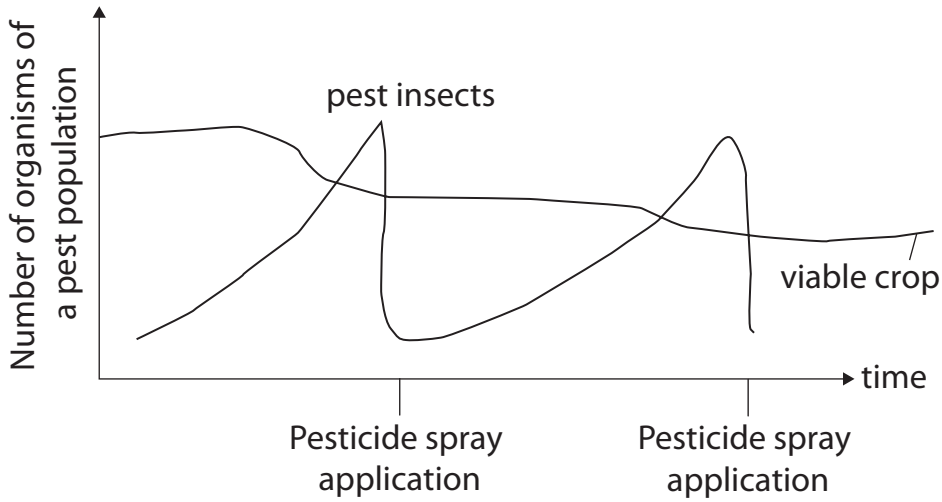
Throughout the world, much of our f__ __d is grown in **monocultures**. This means that one cr__p is grown over vast areas, and any c__mp__t__ ng weeds or other plants are removed by the farmer. Think of the huge paddocks of wh__ __t in Australia as an example, or rice in __s__ __. M__n__c__lt__r__s are easy to manage. Uniform q__ __nt__t__ __s of fertiliser are applied and **irrigation** is used if needed. The crop can be harvested without any c__nt__m__n__t__ __n from other species. However, monocultures are highly susceptible to __tt__ck from pests and diseases. This is because they are an enormous food source that l__cks the d__v__rs__ty and r__s__st__nc__ that would be found in a n__t__r__lly occurring environment.

2 Are these statements true or false?

Monocultures are resistant to pests. _____

Wheat is grown as a monoculture in Australia. _____

Monocultures need protection from pests and diseases. _____



3 Examine the graph above. Why do insect numbers rise rapidly? _____

_____

4 Why does the farmer need to spray again? _____

_____

© Beth Montgomery and Blake Education 2012
ISBN 978 1 92571 041 0